Badiou had already elaborated a similar critique in *Portées du mot "juif"* [Uses of the Word "Jew" (2005)], a collection of essays dating back to the 1980s, to which an essay by Cécile Winter has been appended. In this bizarre and troubling book, Badiou maintains that antisemitism should not be examined separately from other racisms, for to do so places

> the word "Jew," and the community claiming to stand for it. . .in a paradigmatic position with respect to the field of values, cultural hierarchies, and in evaluating the politics of states.[12]

He means by this that any attempt to say that the persecution of Jews is unique or not the same as racism against blacks or Arabs—and he's mainly referring to the discourse surrounding the Shoah although he interestingly collapses this discourse into the discourse surrounding the "new antisemitism"—commits the sin of according to a single community, the Jewish community, a paradigmatic or "transcendental" significance, which is a violation of universalism.

To be fair, Badiou in theory opposes any "identitary predicate," any kind of identity label attached to people or to states, but he believes the Nazi experience has made Jewish identity particularly toxic. According to Badiou's logic, Hitler has forever tainted the word "Jew" and made it dangerous to use as a marker of group belonging. Hence the Jews who identify overtly as Jews become Nazis because they are using a word that Hitler used.[13] In the text by Cécile Winter, included in Badiou's book, the word "Jew" is referred to as "the master-signifier of the new Aryans." Winter, who proclaims her own Jewishness by disavowing it, thus becomes another in a long line of Jewish co-authors (along with Hazan and Segré) whose Jewish background helps legitimate Badiou's attack on Jewish identity. Note Badiou's hypocrisy in proudly naming his co-authors as Jews when it serves his purposes despite his supposed hostility to such identity labels.

All identity distinctions, all community formations, and all national allegiances become suspect in Badiou's extreme version of universalism. Of all the nations in the world, however, Israel is the only one that Badiou calls out for its nationalism, just as the Jews are the only people whom he faults for communitarianism. This is because, like Saint Paul, Badiou makes the Jews into a metaphor both of what the universal should be—"In the meantime, we can try. . .to agree upon a meaning for the word 'Jew' that would have universal import" (165)—and of all that the universal is not. As in his preface to Segré, Badiou accomplishes this redefinition of the Jew by splitting the "real" Jews, the ethical or spiritual or universal Jews, from the false or ethnic or particularist Jews—the same procedure used by a variety of other recent anti-Zionist thinkers, including Judith Butler and Enzo Traverso.[14] Only those

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